WEBINAR MODULE 5

Building a Sovereign American Workforce Strategy

Skills, Pipelines & Productive Capability

Joshua Konkle · Operator — configuration and execution

What You Will Leave With

- Clarity on the difference between managing headcount and building sovereign capability
- A practical frame for redesigning workforce strategy around American talent pipelines
- A live policy example of sovereign workforce action in progress
- An exercise to map one critical role family and begin building a real pipeline

Completing the Series Arc

By this point the full arc is clear:

1	2	3	4	5
Business Model Canvas	OKRs as a System	Operating Model + SI	Value Streams / Lean	Workforce Strategy

The Productive Pragmatism Frame

Workforce strategy is no longer a support function — it is one of the primary ways an organization builds or erodes long-term competitive position

01

Sovereign Productive Base

Build and control critical capabilities inside the United States

02

Merit & Capability

Develop real skill among American citizens with long-term stake

03

Directed Improvement

Capital and effort flow toward domestic capacity, not temporary labor extraction

04

People, Process, Place

High-capability American workers + advanced processes + domestic locations

Current Reality

- Ongoing difficulty developing and retaining skilled trades and technical talent among American workers
- Growing dependence on temporary or short-cycle non-sovereign labor for core roles
- Loss of institutional knowledge every time a rotation ends
- Innovation and continuous-improvement capacity that never compounds

Diagnostic Questions

Every leadership team should be able to answer these:

1. Which role families are truly critical to our productive capacity over the next 3–5 years?

2. What percentage of those roles are filled by long-term American workers versus temporary or short-cycle non-sovereign labor?

3. Do we have deliberate pipelines (internal development, apprenticeships, veterans pathways, local partnerships) that produce American talent for those roles?

4. Are we measuring success by capability growth and retention — or primarily by time-to-fill and labor cost?

Two Competing Models

SHORT-CYCLE LABOR MODEL

“How do we keep the seats filled at the lowest possible cost?”

Optimizes for speed-to-fill, cost-per-hire, and maximum labor flexibility — often via temporary non-sovereign labor.

SOVEREIGN CAPABILITY MODEL

“How do we build a workforce that gets better every year and makes the operation harder to copy?”

Optimizes for compounding capability, knowledge retention, and high-skill American talent.

Current Example – Sovereign Workforce in Action

Department of Transportation / Freedom Haulers

Rather than treating CDL driving roles as a permanent temporary-labor problem, the department is actively removing non-sovereign drivers and expanding pathways for American veterans who already possess the relevant experience through programs such as Freedom Haulers.

This approach simultaneously strengthens the domestic workforce and contributes to a more secure supply chain.

It is what a sovereign workforce strategy looks like in practice: identify the critical capability, stop defaulting to short-cycle non-sovereign labor, and deliberately build an American pipeline that compounds skill and reliability over time.

American System Redesign Principles

Treat talent development as investment

Development of American talent in critical roles is a strategic investment in productive capacity, not merely a cost.

Design deliberate pipelines

Internal mobility, apprenticeships, veterans pathways, and local partnerships that produce people who stay long enough to master and improve the work.

Measure what matters

Capability growth, retention of high performers, contribution to innovation, and reduction in dependence on temporary non-sovereign labor.

Use technology to elevate roles

Automation eliminates low-value tasks while expanding higher-skill American roles in engineering, maintenance, and continuous improvement.

Exercise

Choose one critical role family.
Map the current reality — how these roles are actually filled today.

Then sketch what a deliberate 3–5 year American talent pipeline would need to include:

- **Sources**
- **Development steps**
- **Retention logic**
- **Success metrics**

Directing SI in Workforce Strategy

The human owns direction, decisions, standards, review, and final release. SI tools extend the work.

Human instruction: “Read the last 90 days of the named critical seat family’s pipeline data and exit reasons from these sources I am supplying. Return a one-page note that names which seats still depend on short-cycle temporary or visa design, which have a citizen pipeline, and one seat family that needs an owner. Do not recommend staffing changes.”

Bot’s bounded task: Collect and draft the one-page note from the named sources only. Stop at the draft. Do not post, do not change any file, do not invent a seat recommendation.

Review criteria: (1) Every claim has a named source. (2) Open items are listed, not solved. (3) No staffing or cost-cutting recommendations are added; relevant source facts remain accurately reported. (4) The note is one page.

Human release decision: Human reads the draft against the four criteria. If all four pass, human marks it ready and releases it. If any fail, human returns it with the failed criterion named. The bot does not self-release.

Name one critical seat family. Write the four-part split for one use of SI in reviewing its pipeline. Done when the four-part split is written.

Three Highest-Leverage Moves

1 Identify the two or three role families most critical to long-term productive capacity and measure how dependent they currently are on temporary or short-cycle non-sovereign labor.

2 Design one concrete pipeline action (internal development, apprenticeship, veterans pathway, or local partnership) that begins reducing that dependence within 12 months.

3 Align the redesigned workforce strategy with the full series: Canvas → OKRs → Operating Model → Value Streams → Workforce.

Series Complete

Canvas → OKRs → Operating Model → Value Streams → Workforce Strategy

Each tool now points in the same direction —
building sovereign American productive capability.

For a concrete 90-day execution plan or ongoing Chief of Staff-style implementation support, reach out directly.

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